fails to take into account the varied manifestations and the transformations of Zionism, or the attempt of many Zionists to implement socialist, rather than imperialist aims. For these reasons, postcolonial theory, argues Gideon Shimoni, cannot provide a useful analytical tool for understanding the Arab-Israel conflict.[32] In this common falsification of history, as Ivan Davidson Kalmar and Derek Penslar have pointed out in their collection of essays, *Orientalism and the Jews,* the so-called "Zionist myth" is treated solely as a form of colonialism, never *also* as a national liberation movement.[33] Certainly, the leaders of the Yishuv and Zionist historians generally viewed European colonialism with abhorrence. They never saw Jewish-Arab relations in terms of colonizer and colonized, even though "post-Zionist" historians insist that those relations were patronizing and based on "Orientalist" attitudes.[34] Despite the Zionists' suspicion of imperialist powers and their manipulation of Zionism for their own purposes, postcolonialist discourse about Zionism has invariably turned it from an anti-colonialist movement into a state-building enterprise aided and abetted by imperialism.

In *The Question of Zion* (2005), a title that invokes Said, the literary scholar Jacqueline Rose protests against crimes committed on a "daily basis" by the Israeli state "in the name of the Jewish people."[35] Rose distinguishes between anti-Zionists who are opposed to the state of Israel as a colonialist venture and left-wing Zionists who are opposed to the post-1967 occupation of "Palestine."[36] For Rose, however, "Zionism" is a wholly pejorative term—a paradigm of how messianic theology inevitably winds up as a colonialist ideology leading to violence and war.[37] In this emotional and at times almost hysterical rhetoric, Israel is presented as the archetypal nation-state that exemplifies some primal psychopathological urge in humans to wield power over others.[38] Rose claims that Israel has hijacked the vision of the Hebrew Prophets, as well as the anti-terrorist campaign, and that it acts against Jewish ideals of self-determination as well as social justice. It follows that Israel is in some way "anti-Jewish" in that its distorted "messianism" is (psychoanalytically speaking) a form of "collective insanity," ignoring the objective reality which blocks the fulfillment of its dreams and desires.[39] This compulsive neurosis, in Rose's mind, explains why Israel has made of Palestinian Arabs the "Jews' 'jews,'" as if replaying the Holocaust trauma through a trauma it has inflicted on others.[40] By invoking the analogy with the Holocaust, Rose, like so many others, seeks to disqualify the Zionist project. The feminist philosopher Judith Butler in a no less convoluted argument similarly insists that "Zionism" is opposed to the Jewish ethical impetus because of "Israeli state violence" and "colonialism," which displaced Palestinian Arabs in order to establish Jewish sovereignty.[41]

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